Reading Language Arts · Practice Test 1

Read each passage, then answer the questions that follow. Use evidence from the texts.

Passage 1 — The Audition

(1) Maya's fingers hovered over the piano keys. The recital hall was empty except for Ms. Alvarez, who waited with a clipboard and a patient smile. For weeks Maya had practiced the same piece until her hands ached, yet now every note seemed to hide from her.

(2) "Whenever you're ready," Ms. Alvarez said.

(3) Maya's heart thudded. She thought of the school talent show two years earlier, when she had frozen on stage and walked off to a silent crowd. The memory still stung. She almost reached for her bag, ready to leave.

(4) Then she remembered her grandmother's words: "Courage isn't the absence of fear, Maya. It's playing anyway." Maya took a slow breath, closed her eyes, and began.

(5) The first notes trembled, but by the second measure her hands remembered what her mind had forgotten. The music filled the empty hall, rising and falling like waves. When the final chord faded, Maya opened her eyes. She was smiling.

(6) "That," said Ms. Alvarez, setting down her clipboard, "was worth the wait."

(7) Maya walked out lighter than she had entered. The fear had not vanished—but she had played anyway, and that had made all the difference.

1. In paragraph 1, the word *hovered* most nearly means — A. rested lightly B. pressed hard C. slipped off D. disappeared

2. Why does Maya almost reach for her bag? A. She forgot her music B. She recalls freezing at the talent show C. She dislikes Ms. Alvarez D. She is bored

3. The grandmother's words suggest that courage means — A. never feeling afraid B. avoiding challenges C. acting in spite of fear D. practicing more

4. Which statement **best** expresses a theme of the passage? A. Talent is something you are born with B. Facing your fear leads to growth C. Music is too hard for most people D. Teachers are strict

5. The mood at the end of the passage is — A. tense and fearful B. calm and hopeful C. angry D. confused

6. Which sentence **best** shows that Maya has overcome her fear? A. "Her hands ached." B. "Every note seemed to hide from her." C. "She had played anyway, and that had made all the difference." D. "The recital hall was empty."

7. Paragraph 3, about the talent show two years earlier, is an example of — A. foreshadowing B. flashback C. climax D. setting

SCR 1. *(2 points)* How does Maya change from the beginning to the end of the passage? Support your answer with **evidence from the text.**

Passage 2 — Cities Buzz Again

(1) Not long ago, honeybees were a rare sight in big cities. Today, hives sit on rooftops, in community gardens, and even atop hotels. Urban beekeeping is growing fast—and cities are better for it.

(2) Bees are pollinators. As they gather nectar, they move pollen from flower to flower, helping plants produce fruits, vegetables, and seeds. A single hive can pollinate millions of flowers in a day. In a city, that means healthier parks, gardens, and street trees.

(3) Urban hives can even be healthier than rural ones. City gardens bloom with many kinds of flowers, so bees enjoy a varied diet. And because many city gardeners avoid heavy pesticides, urban bees may face fewer harmful chemicals than bees near large farms.

(4) Beekeeping also connects people. Neighbors who tend a shared hive learn about nature and work together. Schools use rooftop hives to teach science. Local honey, sold at markets, supports small businesses.

(5) Of course, beekeeping takes training. Beekeepers must know how to handle bees safely and keep hives healthy. But with care, a city hive brings sweet rewards—for people, plants, and the bees themselves.

8. The central idea of the passage is that — A. bees are dangerous in cities B. urban beekeeping benefits cities C. honey is too expensive D. farms no longer have bees

9. The author's main purpose is to — A. entertain with a story B. inform readers about the benefits of urban beekeeping C. sell honey D. warn people to stay away from bees

10. Paragraph 3 is organized mainly by — A. comparing urban and rural hives B. telling a story in order C. listing dangers D. defining a single word

11. As used in paragraph 2, *pollinators* are organisms that — A. make honey only B. move pollen between flowers C. build hives D. sting people

12. Which detail **best** supports the idea that city bees may be healthier than rural bees? A. "hives sit on rooftops" B. "City gardens bloom with many kinds of flowers, so bees enjoy a varied diet." C. "Beekeeping takes training." D. "Local honey supports small businesses."

13. From paragraph 3, the reader can infer that heavy pesticide use — A. helps bees B. has no effect on bees C. can be harmful to bees D. makes more honey

14. Which is the **best** summary of the passage? A. Bees sting, so cities ban them. B. Urban beekeeping is growing and benefits plants, people, and bees, though it takes training. C. Honey tastes sweet. D. Schools have rooftops.

SCR 2. *(2 points)* Explain **one** way urban beekeeping helps a city. Use **evidence from the passage.**

Paired Set — Rooftop Garden & Green Roofs

Text A — "Rooftop Garden" (poem)

Above the traffic's restless hum,
a quiet green begins to climb—
tomatoes red as stoplights,
basil bright with summer time.
Here the city tilts its face
toward sun and rain and seed,
and proves that even concrete
can hold what gardens need.

Text B — "Green Roofs"

Rooftop gardens, or "green roofs," do more than grow food. They soak up rainwater, cool buildings in summer, and give insects and birds a place to rest. Some cities now pay building owners who plant them.

15. In Text A, "tomatoes red as stoplights" is an example of — A. metaphor B. simile C. personification D. alliteration

16. In Text A, "the city tilts its face toward sun" is an example of — A. simile B. personification C. hyperbole D. irony

17. The main idea of Text B is that green roofs — A. are too expensive B. provide several benefits C. only grow food D. damage buildings

18. Both texts suggest that rooftop gardens — A. are impossible in cities B. bring nature into the city C. should replace all parks D. are only for growing food

19. Which idea appears in Text B but **not** in Text A? A. Plants grow on rooftops B. Green roofs soak up rainwater and cool buildings C. Gardens need sun D. Cities are busy

20. Text A is written mainly to — A. inform with facts B. express a feeling about city gardens C. argue a point D. give step-by-step instructions

Revising — "A Recycling Program"

(1) Our school should start a recycling program. (2) Right now, we throw away hundreds of bottles every week. (3) A recycling program would help the environment. (4) It would also teach students good habits. (5) Some students might forget to use the bins at first. (6) But with reminders, it would become normal.

21. Which sentence could **best** be added after sentence 2 to develop the idea with a detail? A. "Recycling is good." B. "Last month our class counted over 400 plastic bottles in the trash." C. "I like our school." D. "The bins are blue."

22. Which transition would **best** begin sentence 4? A. However, B. For example, C. In addition, D. Although

23. What is the **best** way to combine sentences 3 and 4? A. ...environment, it also teaches good habits. B. A recycling program would help the environment and teach students good habits. C. ...environment, and, teaching good habits. D. Helping the environment and good habits a recycling program.

24. Which sentence **best** states the writer's main claim (thesis)? A. Sentence 1 B. Sentence 2 C. Sentence 5 D. Sentence 6

Editing — "The Science Museum"

(1) My family and me visited the science museum last Saturday. (2) The exhibit about space were amazing. (3) We seen a real moon rock and a model rocket. (4) Its hard to believe how big the universe is.

25. What change should be made in sentence 1? A. Change "me" to "I" B. Change "visited" to "visit" C. Change "last" to "latest" D. No change

26. What change should be made in sentence 2? A. Change "were" to "was" B. Change "about" to "of" C. Change "exhibit" to "exhibits" D. No change

27. What change should be made in sentence 3? A. Change "seen" to "saw" B. Change "real" to "really" C. Change "rock" to "rocks" D. No change

28. What change should be made in sentence 4? A. Change "Its" to "It's" B. Change "believe" to "belief" C. Change "how" to "how is" D. No change

Extended Constructed Response (ECR) — *(10 points)*

Passage 2, "Cities Buzz Again," describes the benefits of urban beekeeping. **Should your community start an urban beekeeping or rooftop-garden program?** Write a multi-paragraph **argumentative essay** that states your position and supports it with reasons and evidence, including evidence from the passage. Organize your essay with an introduction, body paragraphs, and a conclusion, and use correct grammar and spelling.

Answers and full explanations for this test are in Part 3 · Answer Keys & Explanations.